

Dillon G. Isaacs Tse, MS

Location: San Luis Obispo, CA; Seeking Remote Opportunities

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Clearance: Active Top Secret Clearance

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SUMMARY

DevOps Architect with 14+ years of experience working alongside highly technical engineering teams to bring innovative and secure cloud-native solutions from concept to implementation. Hands-on leader focused on leveraging the latest technologies and techniques to design, develop, and support high-performance, high-availability cloud infrastructure at scale.

SKILLS

- **DevOps:** Capacity Planning, Distributed Systems, Infrastructure as Code (IaC), CI/CD, Architecture Design & Coding, Platform Engineering, GitOps, Containerization, Monitoring & Alerting, Log Analysis, Scalability, Performance, Site Reliability Engineering, Software Quality, Automation, Cloud-Native Solutions, Observability, Cybersecurity, Data Security, Security Controls, System Administration, Root Cause Analysis, Technical Documentation
- **Leadership:** Strategic Planning & Execution, Program Development, Project Management, Process Improvement, Change Management, Cross-functional Collaboration, Stakeholder Engagement, Interdepartmental Alignment, Staff Management, Coaching & Mentorship, Budgeting & Resource Allocation, Executive Reporting
- **Tech:** TypeScript, Kubernetes, GitLab, AWS Cloud Development Kit (CDK), Terraform, MySQL, DynamoDB, HashiCorp Vault

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

DevOps Architect, Aviture

September 2021 - Present

- Developed and maintained 44 GitLab and 213 Jenkins pipelines for build, quality, compliance, and deployment processes.
- Ensure 99.6% compliance with 822 NIST 800-53 security controls by automating vulnerability, dependency, deployment scripts, and compliance scanning processes with scripts and Ansible.
- Architected and maintained scalable AWS infrastructure using Infrastructure as Code (IaC) practices with AWS Cloud Development Kit, TypeScript, and Terraform, and migrated 8,094 AWS resources from manual provisioning to IaC, significantly enhancing reliability, disaster recovery, security, and operational efficiency.
- Reduced the cost of GitLab compute by 28% by standing up self-hosted runners on AWS EKS using spot instances and a custom autoscaler that enabled system downtime during off-hours while being available to scale back up via webhook.
- Reduced email-service weekly errors from 1100 to 0 weekly errors by updating the configuration to allow the email payload to be received by Lambda multiple times within a given time and enable retries in the event of transient failures.
- Resolved a recurring OOM error in the Strapi CMS, causing crashes every 3 days; achieved a 70% cache hit ratio on high-cardinality keys and generated \$2400 a year in cost savings by advising against a new Redis service for issue resolution.
- Implemented CI/CD practices for build, test, versioning, and deployment automation that provided the team with the confidence to automatically deploy changes as they're merged into the version control system.
- Developed a custom Playwright Slack reporter plugin to automatically post test reports to the 24-person team's Slack channel when tests are complete in the CI/CD pipeline, reducing the time needed to review tests by 80%.
- Deployed application and infrastructure monitoring solutions using Prometheus and AWS CloudWatch to allow the team to learn about issues in the system and release fixes more quickly, optimize design decisions, and improve response times.
- Improved mean time to respond to faults by 67% by creating and integrating metrics-driven alerts with Slack for efficient team communication and proactive incident management.
- Provisioned and managed 6 Kubernetes clusters and implemented resource quotas/limits and autoscaling to ensure reliability, scalability, and efficient app orchestration.
- Eliminated unnecessary system throttles and generated \$5K in cost savings by analyzing Lambda and DynamoDB execution and throttle metrics to inform the configuration and tuning of concurrency and provisioning/on-demand, and switching over-provisioned DDB tables to on-demand.
- Triaged and resolved system outages and issues, including data leaks within IL4 environments, while continuously ensuring compliance with security and operational standards.
- Maintained the lifecycle of domain TLS certificates, including issuance, renewal, and deployment, by generating Certificate Signing Requests (CSRs), preparing and submitting requests to DISA, and installing the certificates once issued.
- Improved developer security by implementing required MFA for CLI execution; permissive credentials removed from developer profiles, time-bound credentials granted after MFA authentication.

Information System Security Officer, Aviture**September 2021 - Present**

- Implemented, updated, and managed information system security policies focused on access control, audits, accountability, config management, contingency plan, authentication, incident response, and program management, while ensuring alignment with federal standards, including NIST SP 800-53 and NIST SP 800-37.
- Generated \$124K+ in cost savings by independently managing the Authority to Operate process, including preparing documentation packages, managing Plan of Action and Milestones, and interfacing with Authorizing Officials (AOs).
- Achieved 99.6% compliance with 822 RMF security controls and received authority to operate on schedule.
- Ensured system configurations met security baselines, including STIGs and organization-specific hardening requirements, and identified and remediated 6 critical security vulnerabilities that would have denied the program ATO.
- Collaborated with system owners, administrators, and other stakeholders to implement and verify corrective actions for identified security deficiencies with a focus on safeguarding private data that has the potential to be leaked.

Software Engineer I, Raytheon Technologies**May 2018 - September 2021**

- Designed, implemented, and debugged the mission data processing platform's core services for securely onboarding and hosting third-party mission satellite data processing applications.
- Developed Kubernetes and OpenShift manifests to deploy applications and infrastructure components.
- Reduced deployment time to 15 minutes from 2 hours by developing Ansible playbooks to streamline all aspects of configuration and deployment across multiple environments.
- Addressed static code analysis and scan reports from hundreds of CVEs and CWEs to support security accreditation.
- Collaborated with third-party developers to modernize legacy systems with a focus on eliminating monolithic applications.

Career Enlisted Aviator (Staff Sergeant) - Offutt Air Force Base, United States Air Force**June 2011 - June 2018**

- Served as a Flight Instructor to train and mentor 125+ Airmen on the duties of Technical Controller, Radio Operator, & Senior Leadership Communication Systems Operator positions, and ensure formal flight qualification for Boeing E-4 B aircraft.
- Recognized with a variety of awards, including Airman of the Quarter and Distinguished Graduate, 3 separate times.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- Master of Science in Computer Science, University of Nebraska
- Bachelor of Science in Software Development, Bellevue University
- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP), ISC2 (IAT Level 3)
- CompTIA Security+, CompTIA (IAT Level 2)